



Deepeners and Deepening Suggestions

This is an often-discussed topic, so I urge you to not fall into a trap of thinking “deepening” is the answer to any challenge you might have with a client. Some newer practitioners and many clients will claim “they are not deep enough” when the issue at hand may very well be something else.

That being said here are some deepening suggestions:

- Lowering, slowing and softening your own voice, and watching your energy as the facilitator, is the best thing you can do to encourage more relaxation from your client.
- Suggest breathing, “Now I want you to just take some nice slow, deep breaths. Just breath in.... and out.... In and out.... Getting deeper with every breath.”
- Suggest decent imagery of some kind. “So now we are just going to imagine we are floating down a beautiful path, down... down... down... just floating down.” Emphasize the word down.
- Many hypnosis practitioners use progressive relaxation. Having the client go through their body and systematically make each part heavy and warm.
- Counting backwards with numbers is a traditional way to deepen.
- Relaxing and doubling. “Feeling relaxed now, so relaxed, as relaxed as you can be and then... you are twice as relaxed as that. Even more relaxed than before and you can double that relaxation again with just a simple breath. Again, you are twice as relaxed as before....”

A quick internet search of “hypnotic deepeners” will bring also bring up thousands of results of various kinds from various sources.